

Session 2 — «بارہ سال»

ابو بکر الصديق 's caliphate entire · 11–13 AH / 632–634 CE

Read this twice at home. It never goes to the lectern — that is what CUE.pdf is for. Its whole job is to put the evening into your head so completely that on the night you are telling it, not reading it. Everything here comes from SPINE.md ; nothing has been added.

Where we are

Session 1 stopped on a morning. سقيفة was over, the ummah had a caliph, and the room was shown a map of Arabia with the ردة about to break across it. Then the lights came up. Tonight opens on that same map, unchanged, and starts moving it.

Tonight is **two years and three months**. That is the whole span. أبو بکر became caliph and died inside it, and inside it Arabia came apart and was put back together, the Qur'an was gathered into one set of صحف for the first time, and the first armies left the peninsula. The room will not believe how short it is — which is why the evening opens with a hands-up on exactly that.

The verdict after session 1 was that it felt like a speed-run. So tonight is one caliphate, told slowly, in scenes: a dozen stories told properly, with the map doing the joining.

The one thing the evening is actually about. Every scene tonight is a man being told, by people who love him and are not fools, to bend — and not bending. Send the army later. Give us an older commander. Keep the troops here. Do not do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do. Take a salary you were lawfully voted. Each time he answers, and each answer is short. That is the thread. If you have to cut half the evening, keep the thread.

ACT 1 • The army he would not call back

11 AH • the first ten days

👏 **[HANDS]** Hands up — how long do you think أبو بكر was caliph, in total?

(Two years and three months. Everything tonight happens inside that.)

1 • The appointment nobody liked

In his last weeks the Prophet ﷺ raised an army for the Syrian frontier and put أسامة بن زيد over it. أسامة was eighteen. Standing in the ranks under him were عمر بن الخطاب and the senior men of the مهاجرون and the أنصار. People said so out loud — an eighteen-year-old over these men. The Prophet ﷺ heard the talk, stood up, and answered it himself.

The audience will not expect the map to point where it points here. The arrow goes north-west, past تبوك, toward البلقاء and أبنى — Byzantine ground. This is the first time in the series the map looks at an empire.

The statement is the Prophet's ﷺ own, and it does two things at once: defends أسامة, and tells the room how the Prophet ﷺ regarded him and his father.

إِنْ تَطْعُنُوا فِي إِمَارَتِهِ فَقَدْ كُنْتُمْ تَطْعُنُونَ فِي إِمَارَةِ أَبِيهِ مِنْ قَبْلُ، وَإِنَّمَا اللَّهُ إِنْ كَانَ خَلِيفًا لِلْإِمَارَةِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ لِمَنْ أَحَبَّ النَّاسَ إِلَيَّ، وَإِنَّ هَذَا لِمَنْ أَحَبَّ النَّاسَ إِلَيَّ بَعْدَهُ

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٥ ص ٣١١ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2495>

English: "If you find fault with his command, you found fault with his father's command before

him. And by Allah, he was fit for command, and he was among the dearest of people to me — and this

one is among the dearest of people to me after him."

عبرت: A man is fit for a task because of what he can do, not because of how long he has been alive.

2 • "I will not untie a knot"

Then the Prophet ﷺ died, and the situation inverted. Tribes around المدينه broke away. Others refused the زكاة. And the state's only field army was outside the walls, pointed at the Roman frontier and marching away from the capital.

The advice to recall it came from the best men he had. عمرؓ was among them. The advice was correct by every ordinary measure. He refused it, and he refused hard.

والذي نفس أبي بكر بيده لو ظننت أن السباع تخطفني لأنفذت بعث أسامة كما
أمر به رسول الله ﷺ؛ ولو لم يبق في القرى غيري لأنفذته

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٠ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3156>

English: "By Him in whose hand is أبو بكر's soul — if I thought the wild beasts would snatch me away, I would still send out أسامة's expedition as the Messenger of Allah ﷺ ordered it. And if there were no one left in the settlements but me, I would still send it."

عبرت: There is a kind of steadiness that is not stubbornness: it is refusing to treat an emergency as permission.

On the sources: the connected narrative here runs through سيف بن عمر; the wording at ج ٧ ص ١١ comes by a separate route. You do not need to say that on stage. You need to know it if a slip asks.

3 • The beard, and the man who would not be deposed

The column had reached الجُزْف, one march out. The أنصار in it sent عمرؓ back with a second, much softer request — not "cancel the march", but "give us an older commander." عمرؓ carried the message. أبو بكرؓ had been sitting on the ground. He came up off it, took عمرؓ by the beard, and answered in one sentence.

ثَكَلَتْكَ أُمُّكَ يَا ابْنَ الْخُطَّابِ! اسْتَغْمَلَهُ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - وَتَأْمُرُنِي
أَنْ أَعْزِلَهُ؟!

— الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ١٩٥ — <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/886>

English: "May your mother lose you, son of الخطاب! The Messenger of Allah ﷺ appointed him — and you order me to depose him?"

عبرت: Authority that can be renegotiated the moment its author is gone was never authority.

4 • The caliph on foot

Then he walked the army out himself. Hold this picture for the room, because it is a picture and it needs no commentary: the caliph of the Muslims on foot in the dust; the eighteen-year-old commander in the saddle; عبد الرحمن بن عوف behind them leading the caliph's riding-beast, empty. أسامة could not bear it and offered to get down. He was refused.

And at the end أبو بكر asked one favour — and asked it of أسامة, not of عمر, because أسامة was the commander and عمر was in his army: *would you release عمر to me?*

فقال أسامة: يا خليفة رسول الله: إما أن تركب وإما أن أنزل، فقال: والله لست
بنازل ولست براكب

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3157>

English: "أسامة said: 'O successor of the Messenger of Allah, either you ride or I dismount.' He said: 'By Allah, you shall not dismount, and I shall not ride.'"

عبرت: Rank is a place in an order, not a claim about who is the better man.

5 • Forty days, and what the tribes concluded

The column marched north through country that was ready to rise, and it did not fight its way through — it simply passed. And the men watching it pass drew the only conclusion available to them: nobody sends an army *away* unless he has more behind him. Forty days later — some say seventy — it came back whole and carrying spoil.

On the map, watch what happens: the arrow goes out, strikes, comes back, and the ring of hostile clans around المدينة **thins** instead of closing.

فجعل لا يمر بقبيل يريدون الارتداد إلا قالوا: لولا أن لهؤلاء قوة ما خرج مثل هؤلاء
من عندهم

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3157>

English: "He passed no tribe intending to break away but they said: 'Were it not that these people have strength, men like these would not have gone out from among them.'"

عبرت: What people believe about your strength does as much work as your strength does.

What the sources disagree about, and you should know: the blow the column struck is described differently in different books — a raid on أبنى in the البلقاء, or on قُضاعة clans that had broken away, or a clash with Roman forces. The two books that comment on the *effect* — البداية ج ٧ ص ١١ and الكامل ج ٢ ص ١٩٦ — agree on it. سير ج ٢ ص ٤٩٧ names the target and says nothing about the effect, so do not enlist it for that. The forty days puts the return in جمادى, but **the month of the return is our arithmetic**, not a dated report on any page we have read. Do not state it as a date.

Telling it: About five minutes. This is the easiest act to tell and the best place to settle your voice, so take it slowly and do not rush the first hands-up — let the guesses come, let them be wrong, then give the number. The two beats to pause on are the beard and the caliph walking; pause *after* the beard line, not before. If you are running long, card 3 can go — card 4 absorbs its point. **What not to say:** do not editorialise about عمر^{رضي} being wrong. He gave the advice any responsible man would give, and the story is far better if the room understands that the advice was *good* and was refused anyway.

If a slip asks — "why put an eighteen-year-old over عمر^{رضي}?" The page is open: the Prophet ﷺ was asked that in his own lifetime and answered it himself. Card 1's quotation is the answer, and it is about fitness, not age. **If a slip asks whether عمر^{رضي} and أبو بكر^{رضي} quarrelled** — this is one government making a decision, not a dispute between Companions, and the same عمر^{رضي} is the man he later names as his successor. Go no further. If the slip is really reaching toward the مشاجرات, use the deferral line from QA_BANK.md §0: it is handled with اصول in session 3, and you do not adjudicate from the floor.

ACT 2 • Arabia comes apart

11 AH

6 • The night raid on Medina

The delegation that had offered the prayer and refused the رِكَاة went home. On the way out, they counted the men in the city.

Three days later the raiders came at night. Half of them stayed back at a valley called ذُو حُسى as a reserve. أَبُو بَكْر came out with whoever was in the mosque, on the watering-camels, and drove the raiders off — and then pursued them straight into the reserve, which rolled inflated skins down at the Muslims' camels. The camels bolted and carried their riders all the way home.

Flag this to the room as a surprise: the first engagement of the رِدَّة war was a reverse, and the book records it without embarrassment.

فَخَرَجَ عَلَيْهِمُ الرِّدَّةُ بِأَنْحَاءٍ قَدْ تَفَخُّوْهَا ... فَتَفَرَّتْ إِبِلُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَهُمْ عَلَيْهَا،
وَرَجَعَتْ بِهِمْ إِلَى الْمَدِينَةِ، وَلَمْ يُصْرَعْ مُسْلِمٌ.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/893> · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٠٢

English: "The reserve came out at them with skins they had inflated ... The Muslims' camels bolted with them on their backs and carried them back to Medina — and not one Muslim was thrown."

عبرت: The first engagement of the war was a setback, and the book records it without embarrassment.

Map caution: ذُو حُسى is a valley in the country of عَبَس and غُظْفَان. **No page we have gives its distance from المدينة, so do not name one.**

7 • The counter-attack before dawn

They thought the Muslims were finished. He spent that same night forming his men up — the three brothers of Muqarrin on the right, the left and the rear — and marched in the dark. At first light the two forces were standing on the same ground and the enemy had

not heard them come. The swords were among them before the sun's rim showed. By sunrise they were running.

He pursued, camped at ذُو الْقِصَّةِ, left a detachment there under al-Nu'mān b. Muqarrin^{رض}, and went home.

فَمَا طَلَعَ الْفَجْرُ إِلَّا وَهُمْ وَالْعَدُوُّ عَلَى صَعِيدٍ وَاحِدٍ ... فَمَا ذَرَّ قَرْنُ الشَّمْسِ حَتَّى
وَلَّوْهُمْ الْأَذْبَارَ ... وَكَانَ أَوَّلَ الْفَتْحِ.

— الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/894>

English: "Dawn did not break until they and the enemy were on one ground ... and the sun's rim had not risen before they turned their backs ... and that was the first victory."

عبرت: The recovery came out of the very night the reverse happened, spent preparing.

👏 [HANDS] Hands up — Medina is one town. How many armies would you send out at once?

8 • Eleven banners at ذُو الْقِصَّةِ

This is the evening's biggest map moment. Do not spend it quickly.

He rode out a third time with his sword drawn, and 'Alī^{رض} walked at his camel's head. This time the Companions would not let him go on. He agreed — and then, on that ground, tied eleven banners, gave each commander his objective and his written orders, and went back to المدينة. The eleven separated, each with his own troops joining him, and rode off in eleven directions from one spot of desert.

On screen: one dot at ذُو الْقِصَّةِ, one day out from المدينة, and eleven arrows leaving it at once — north-east to نجد, east to اليمامة, north to الشام and to قُضَاعَة, south-east to البحرين, far east to عمان, south-east to مَهْرَة, south to اليمن and to تِهَامَة, south to حضرموت. They go up as outlines and fill in one by one across the rest of the evening. Count them out loud with the room.

فَفَصَلَتِ الْأُمَرَاءُ مِنْ ذِي الْقَصَصَةِ، وَلَحِقَ بِكُلِّ أَمِيرٍ جُنْدُهُ، وَعَهَدَ إِلَى كُلِّ أَمِيرٍ.

— ٢٠٤ ص ٢ الكامل · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/895>

English: "The commanders separated from Dhū al-Qaṣṣa, and each commander's troops joined him, and he gave each commander his commission."

عبرت: The whole war was set moving from one camp, in one sitting, by a man who had just been told to go home.

⚠ **Know this before you go on stage.** Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله announces eleven and prints ten; **prints all eleven**. If a listener has counted ten in another book, that is why. And **do not name the ninth commander** — three sources give three forms of the name.

9 • The letter that went ahead of the armies

Before the armies came, the letters came. One wording, copied out many times, carried by messengers who rode ahead of the columns, and read aloud in every assembly of the tribe.

The thing worth stopping on is what the letter contains: a single test that any man could apply from a distance, with no lawyer and no court. Call the adhān when you halt. If they answer it, stop. If they do not, ask them what they owe.

وقد أمرتُ رسولي أن يقرأ كتابه في كلِّ جَمْعٍ لَكُمْ، والداعية الأذان، فإذا إِذَّنَ المسلمون فأذنوا فكُفُّوا عنهم، وإن لم يُؤدِّنوا فسلوهم ما عليهم.

— ٢٤ ص ٧ البدايه والنهايه · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3170>

English: "I have ordered my messenger to read his letter in every assembly of yours. The summons is the adhān: when the Muslims call it and they call it too, hold off from them; and if they do not call it, ask them what they owe."

عبرت: The test was something the other side could pass, and passing it stopped the war where they stood.

⚠ **The same letter contains a harsh clause. Do not quote it and do not deny it.** If a slip raises it: it is on that page, transmitted by سيف بن عمر; the operative test on the same page is the adhān; and the question of the clause is for the fuqahā', not for you. That is logged in [QA_BANK.md](#).

10 • بُرَاخَة — the man who walked off the field

Ṭulayḥa sat wrapped in a cloak, waiting for revelation, while 'Uyayna b. Ḥiṣn did the fighting with seven hundred men of Fazāra. Nearby, Banū 'Āmir sat armed and watched to see which way it would go. Three times 'Uyayna broke off the fighting, walked back to the cloak, and asked whether Jibrīl had come. Twice the answer was no. The third time it was yes — and then Ṭulayḥa told him what had been said.

Let the room hear the revelation before you comment on it. It is a mill, and a matter you will not forget. It says nothing. That is the point.

قَالَ لِي: إِنَّ لَكَ رَحًا كَرَحَاهُ، وَحَدِيثًا لَا تَنْسَاهُ. فَقَالَ عُيَيْنَةُ: قَدْ عَلِمَ اللَّهُ أَنَّهُ سَيَكُونُ
حَدِيثٌ لَا تَنْسَاهُ، انْصَرِفُوا يَا بَنِي فَزَارَةَ فَإِنَّهُ كَذَّابٌ.

— ٢٠٥ ص · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/896>

English: "He said to me: you have a mill like his mill, and a matter you will not forget. 'Uyayna

said: Allah knows there will be a matter you will not forget. Withdraw, Banū Fazāra — the man is a liar."

عبرت: The claim collapsed the moment somebody asked it for something specific.

Ṭulayḥa's own exit is on the same page and it is worth having: he had a horse ready and a mount for his wife, got away with her, and called back over his shoulder — «يَا مَعْشَرَ فَزَارَةَ، — "whoever can do this and get away with his wife, let him do it." On the map a thin red line then runs from بُرَاخَة north-west, all the way to الشام.

11 • The terms at Medina, and عمر's objection

The delegation of بُزَاخَة came to المدينة asking for terms. أَبُو بَكْر gave them a choice of two and named them: a war of expulsion, or a humbling settlement. They said they knew what war meant — what was the settlement? He listed it. Weapons and horses surrendered. Compensation for what you took from us, and none for what we took from you. You testify that our dead are in the Garden and yours in the Fire. And you pay blood-money for our dead, and we pay none for yours.

And then عمر interrupted him — in public, in front of the men the terms applied to — and struck one clause out.

فَقَالَ عُمَرُ: أَمَا قَوْلُكَ: تَدُونَ قَتْلَانَا، فَإِنَّ قَتْلَانَا قَتَلُوا عَلَى أَمْرِ اللَّهِ لَا دِيَاتَ لَهُمْ ...
وقال عمر في الثاني: نعم ما رأيت.

صحيح البخاري ٧٢٢١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3173> — البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٢٧ —

English: "Umar said: as for your saying 'and you pay blood-money for our dead' — our dead were killed upon the command of Allah; there is no blood-money for them ... And 'Umar said of the rest:
excellent is what you have judged."

عبرت: The terms were read out in front of the men they applied to, and one clause of them was struck out in public.

Two additions, both on the page and both useful. Ibn Mas'ūd defines the first option — بُزَاخَة: «وَأَمَّا الْحَرْبُ الْمُجْلِيَّةُ فَأَنْ يُخْرِجُوا مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠١). And **no captives were taken at** بُزَاخَة: «فَأَمَنَهُمْ ... وَلَمْ يُؤْخَذْ مِنْهُمْ سَبْيٌ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٦). Say the second one. The room will assume captives were taken; the page says they were not, and there is no captives marker on the map.

Telling it: About five minutes, and this act has the most moving parts — so hold the running order in your head rather than the detail: *raid* → *reverse* → *night march* → *victory* → *eleven banners* → *letters* → بُزَاخَة → *terms*. Seven beats. The second hands-up sits between beat four and beat five and does real work: let them guess two, or three, then put eleven arrows on the screen. If you are running long, tell card 6's reverse in two sentences and drop the Banū 'Āmir detail from card 10; **card 8 must not be shortened. What not to**

say: do not call the ردة a rebellion of hypocrites or characterise the tribes' motives beyond what the pages say, and do not let the word "apostasy" do more work than the letter does — the letter's own test is the adhān.

If a slip asks — "were these wars fought against Muslims?" Open the page rather than argue. The letter sets a low test: call the adhān; if they call it back, hold off. Those who called it were left alone. Beyond that, whether a given group was inside or outside Islam is a question for the fuqahā' — and the honest answer, which is also the disarming one, is that you are reading a book and telling the room what is in it. That is line 3 in `QA_BANK.md` §0, and it is true.

ACT 3 • اليمامة

11–12 AH • the hardest day of the war

12 • The tent and the prisoner — عَقْرَبَاء

Musaylima had about forty thousand fighting men. He camped at عَقْرَبَاء with the farmland and the families behind his back — which meant no man in his line could retreat without running through his own household. Say that plainly and let the room work out what it does to a battle.

The night before, خالد^{رض}'s vanguard picked up a raiding party coming home. He executed them and kept one man alive, because someone in the party told him to: *if you mean anything at all for the people of اليمامة tomorrow, keep this one*. The man was Mujjā'a b. Murāra, and he was put in irons in the tent with خالد^{رض}'s wife, with an instruction to treat him well.

أيها الرجل إن كنت تريد بأهل اليمامة غداً خيراً أو شراً فاستبق هذا الرجل ...
فاستبقاه خالد مقيداً، وجعله في الخيمة مع امرأته، وقال: استوصي به خيراً.

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٣ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3179>

English: "Man — if you intend anything tomorrow for the people of Yamāma, good or ill, keep this man alive ... So Khālid kept him, in irons, and put him in the tent with his wife, and said: treat him well."

عبرت: He kept one prisoner alive on a stranger's advice, and that decision settled the end of the battle before it started.

13 • Thābit b. Qays^{رض} puts on his shroud

Hold the map still for this one. Nothing moves; you are standing on one patch of ground at عَقْرَبَاء while the Muslim line goes backwards.

Anas^{رضي} came to Thābit b. Qays^{رضي} and found him rubbing himself with burial perfume. He had put on two white garments — the ones he was buried in. Anas^{رضي} said: do you not see what is happening? He said: in a moment, nephew. Then he walked forward past the men who were falling back, told them to get out of his way, and said the thing that everyone in that generation would have understood instantly. Then he took the أنصار's banner, dug his feet into the ground to the middle of his shins, and did not move from there until he was killed.

هَكَذَا عَنْ وُجُوهِنَا تَقَارِعُ الْقَوْمَ، بَيْسَ مَا عَوَّدْتُمْ أَقْرَانَكُمْ، مَا هَكَذَا كُنَّا نُقَاتِلُ مَعَ
رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ.

— صحيح البخاري ٢٨٤٥ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1737> · سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣١١

English: "Get out of our faces so we can strike the enemy. Wretched is what you have accustomed

your opponents to! This is not how we used to fight alongside the Messenger of Allah

ﷺ."

عبرت: He did not tell them what to do; he told them what they had already been.

In the same minutes, on the same field — all four verbatim from ج ٧ ص ٣٤ except the last, which is ج ٧ ص ٣٣. Use one or two, not all four; they are there so you have a choice.

- The مهاجرون asked Sālim^{رضي}, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رضي}, whether he feared the line would break from his side — «بَيْسَ حَامِلِ الْقُرْآنِ أَنَا إِذَا».
- Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb^{رضي} — «وَاللَّهِ لَا أَتَكَلَّمُ حَتَّى يَهْزِمَهُمُ اللَّهُ أَوْ أَلْقَى اللَّهُ فَأَكَلِمَهُ بِحَجَّتِي».
- Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رضي} — «يَا أَهْلَ الْقُرْآنِ زَيِّنُوا الْقُرْآنَ بِالْفِعَالِ».
- The whole army calling to each other — «يَا أَصْحَابَ سُورَةِ الْبَقَرَةِ، بَطَلِ السِّحْرِ الْيَوْمَ».

Sālim^{رضي} is the man the Prophet ﷺ went out at night to listen to — سير ج ١ ص ١٦٨. That one line is worth more than any adjective you could add.

14 · حديقة الموت — al-Barā^{رضي} over the wall

When Banū Ḥanīfa broke, one of their commanders called them into a walled garden and shut the gate behind them. Thousands inside, a solid wall, one gate.

al-Barā' b. Mālīk^{رض} — the brother of Anas^{رض} — told the Muslims to throw him over it. They refused. He made them do it. They lifted him on a shield raised on spear-shafts until he topped the wall, and he went down among them alone, fought his way to the gate, and opened it.

On screen the gate is drawn shut. Then it opens **from the inside**.

يَا مَعْشَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، أَتُقُونِي عَلَيْهِمْ فِي الْحَدِيقَةِ. فَقَالُوا: لَا نَفْعَلُ، فَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ
لَتَطْرَحُنِي عَلَيْهِمْ بِهَا! ... وَقَاتَلَ عَلَى الْبَابِ وَفَتَحَهُ لِلْمُسْلِمِينَ.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/909> · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٨

English: "Company of Muslims — throw me over onto them into the garden. They said: we will not.

He said: By Allah, you will throw me onto them in it! ... And he fought at the gate and opened it for the Muslims."

عبرت: One man asked to be thrown where nobody could follow him, and the whole army came in behind him through the gate he opened.

What it cost him — ١٩٦ ص ١ ج ١ سير: «يَوْمَئِذٍ: سِرَ» — some eighty-odd wounds, and خالد^{رض} stayed a month over him treating them. **He survived. Do not say he died there.** Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله appears to list him among the killed; سير contradicts it, and سير is the page we are standing on.

15 · The death of Musaylima, and what Waḥshī^{رض} said afterwards

They got through to him standing in a gap in the wall. Waḥshī b. Ḥarb^{رض} — the man who had killed Ḥamza^{رض} at Uhūd, before he was a Muslim — threw his javelin and it went through him and out the other side; a second man struck him with a sword and he fell. A woman cried out from the fort above.

And afterwards, when Waḥshī^{رض} was asked about that battle, what he said was not about himself.

وَعَنْ وَحْشِيِّ، قَالَ: لَمْ أَرِ قَطُّ أَصْبَرَ عَلَى الْمَوْتِ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ، ثُمَّ ذَكَرَ أَنَّهُ
شَارَكَ فِي قَتْلِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ.

— (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) سير أعلام النبلاء · ص ٤٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1196>

English: "From Wahshī: I never saw men more steadfast in the face of death than Musaylima's companions — then he mentioned that he had a share in killing Musaylima."

عبرت: The man who killed their leader is the one the book quotes praising their courage.

△ **Sources differ on the second man.** الكامل ج ٢؛ Abū Dujāna البدایه ج ٧ ص ٣٤. **Say "a second man came up."** △ And **do not use the anonymous saying on the same** سير **page about the best and the worst of the people of the earth** — it makes a ranking claim the room will want to argue with, and you gain nothing. البدایه's plain apposition is better and safer: *Wahshī b. Ḥarb, who had killed Ḥamza*.

خالد walking the dead with the prisoner — البدایه ج ٧ ص ٣٥ — is the natural close of the act if you want one. He was shown a body and asked, is this him? «لَا، وَاللَّهِ هَذَا خَيْرٌ مِنْهُ». Then they came to a small sallow man, and خالد said: «قَبَّحَكُمْ اللَّهُ عَلَى اتِّبَاعِكُمْ هَذَا» — "May Allah disfigure you for following this."

Telling it: About five minutes, and it is the emotional centre of the first half. Slow right down. The act has no map movement in its middle, deliberately — you are standing still on one field, and the pace should feel different from acts 1 and 2. Three beats: the prisoner, Thābit's shroud, the wall. Take a real pause after «مَا هَكَذَا كُنَّا نَقَاتِلُ مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ» — three full seconds, count them. If you are short, cut the four extra sayings under card 13 to one and cut خالد walking the dead. **What not to say:** do not describe the killing, and do not dwell on numbers here — they come in the next act, where they are the point. And do not let Musaylima become a joke; the sources make the men who followed him serious opponents, and Wahshī's words are there precisely to stop the room laughing at them.

If a slip asks — "how can a man who killed Ḥamza be given?" He accepted Islam. The books name him with the honorific and quote him with respect, and the quotation the deck uses is him praising the courage of the men he had just fought. That is the whole answer, and the page carries it.

ACT 4 • What الإمامة cost, and what it produced

12 AH

16 • The killing ran hot among the reciters

At الإمامة the ردة was broken and Musaylima was killed. Then Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله stops the narrative and counts the cost — which is unusual, and worth telling the room *as* unusual. The dead in the garden and in the battle at close to ten thousand, though he adds that some say twenty-one thousand. The Muslim dead at six hundred, or five hundred. And then he writes *and Allah knows best*.

Among the fallen were men who carried the Qur'an in their memories. His phrase for it is اشتدَّ as استحرَّ القتل في القراء — the killing *ran hot* among the reciters. The editor glosses استحرَّ as grew fierce.

وقتل من المسلمين ستمئة، وقيل: خمسمئة، فإله أعلم، وفيهم من سادات الصحابة،
وأعيان الناس من يُذكر بعد

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٥ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3181>

English: "Six hundred of the Muslims were killed — and it is said five hundred — and Allah knows

best. Among them were leaders of the Companions and men of standing, who will be named later."

عبرت: A generation can carry something priceless and never notice how thin the carrying is until some of it is dropped.

Dates: Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله has الإمامة begun in ١١هـ and finished in ١٢هـ, with «المشهور» at ربيع ١٢هـ; Ibn al-Athīr رحمه الله places it in ١١هـ. Say the span, not a single month. ⚠ **Never put a number of قراء on the slide or in the room — none of our sources gives one.**

17 • "How can we do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do?"

This is the still point of the evening. No map, no movement, المدينة only.

After الإمامة أبو بكر رضي الله عنه sent for زيد بن ثابت رضي الله عنه. Introduce him here, in one breath, because the room needs to know why him: a young man of بنو النجار, eleven years old when the Prophet ﷺ arrived in المدينة, who had memorised seventeen سور before he was introduced, who

learned the Jews' script in a fortnight because the Prophet ﷺ asked him to, and who had written the revelation down as it came.

أبو بكر told him to go and find the whole Qur'an and gather it. And زيد balked — and his objection is the most serious objection there is, which is exactly why the room should hear it in his own words rather than yours.

فَقُلْتُ: كَيْفَ تَفْعَلُونَ شَيْئًا لَمْ يَفْعَلْهُ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ -. قَالَ: هُوَ - وَاللَّهِ - خَيْرٌ. فَلَمْ يَزَلْ أَبُو بَكْرٍ يُرَاجِعُنِي حَتَّى شَرَحَ اللَّهُ صَدْرِي لِلَّذِي شَرَحَ لَهُ صَدْرَ أَبِي بَكْرٍ وَعُمَرُ

— <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2411> · سير أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٤٣١

English: "I said: 'How will you do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do?' He said: 'By

Allah, it is good.' And أبو بكر did not stop coming back to me until Allah opened my breast to

that to which He had opened the breasts of أبو بكر and عمر."

عبرت: The men closest to the Prophet ﷺ were the most afraid of adding to what he ﷺ left — which is exactly why what they did add can be trusted.

18 • Parchment, shoulder-blades, palm-stalks, and the breasts of men

There was no volume to copy from. That is the sentence the room will not have understood before tonight. زيد had to track it down — his own verb is تَتَبَعَ, to follow a thing up piece by piece — and gather it off whatever the Companions had written it on: strips of parchment, the flat shoulder-blades of animals, the bare stalks of palm branches, thin white stones, and out of the memories of the men who had it by heart. Then it was one set of صحف, in one place, for the first time.

فَكُنْتُ أَتَّبِعُ الْقُرْآنَ، أَجْمَعُهُ مِنَ الرِّقَاعِ، وَالْأَكْتَافِ، وَالْعُسْبِ، وَصُدُورِ الرِّجَالِ.

— سیر أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٢٣١ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2411>

English: "So I began to track down the Qur'an, gathering it from the parchments, the shoulder-blades, the palm-stalks, and the breasts of men."

عبرت: Preservation is not one heroic act; it is somebody doing a careful, unglamorous job properly.

A small source note worth having: Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله at ٧٩ ص ٧ names اللِّخَاف — the thin white stones — where الذَّهَبِي رحمه الله names الرِّقَاع. If you want both, say so and cite both. Do not silently merge them.

Telling it: About four minutes, and this is the act to protect at all costs — if the evening runs badly late you cut from acts 6 and 7, never from here. The rhythm is a cost, then a consequence. Do not join them with a lesson; let the room join them. The one piece of stagecraft in the whole evening sits at the end of card 18: say the four things once, slowly, then ask the room to say them back. Parchment. Shoulder-blades. Palm-stalks. The breasts of men. That is the line people repeat in the car. **What not to say:** do not say or imply the Qur'an was at risk of being lost, do not put a number on the قُرَاء who died, and do not stray toward عثمان's later copies — that belongs to a later session, and mixing them is how rooms get confused.

If a slip asks — "so the Qur'an was collected after the Prophet ﷺ?" The page is open and it answers itself. زَيْد raised exactly that objection first, and raised it as an objection. أَبُو بَكْر did not overrule him with authority; he kept coming back to him until زَيْد was convinced. What was gathered was what the Companions already had written and memorised, checked and put in one place. Read the two quotations and stop there. Do not go into methodology, and do not answer a question about the 'Uthmānic copies tonight — say warmly that it belongs to a later session.

ACT 5 • Arabia whole again

12 AH

19 • دارين — into the water

The beaten took ship for دارين, an anchorage a day and a night out from the البحرين shore. This looks like an escape, and the room will assume it was.

al-‘Alā’^{رضي} did not chase them straight away. He first wrote to the Muslims of Bakr b. Wā’il to sit on every road and close the land behind him. Only then did he bring his men to the water's edge — where ships would have been too slow — and tell them what he intended.

قَدْ أَرَأَكُمُ اللَّهُ مِنْ آيَاتِهِ فِي الْبَرِّ لَتَعْتَبِرُوا بِهَا فِي الْبَحْرِ، فَانْهَضُوا إِلَى عَدُوِّكُمْ وَاسْتَعْرِضُوا
الْبَحْرَ.

— ٢٢٤ ص · الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/915>

English: "Allah has shown you of His signs on land so that you may take heed of them at sea. Rise against your enemy, and go straight across the sea."

عبرت: He closed the roads behind the enemy before he opened one in front of himself.

Both books describe the crossing the same way — «يمشون على مثل رملةٍ دمثةٍ فوقها ماء لا يغمر» (البدايه ج ٧ ص ٤٠) — out and back in a single day, with nothing lost in the water except one man's horse-fodder, which al-‘Alā’^{رضي} went back and brought him. ٤٠ ص ٧ ج ٧ البدايه prints the du‘ā’ they said going in. And afterwards: «وَصَرَبَ الْإِسْلَامُ فِيهَا بِجَرَانِهِ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٤).

20 • What Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله says the whole war was

When he finishes the whole account, Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله stops and sums it up himself — and his summary is not the one the room is expecting. He does not describe a conquest. He says there was no region of Arabia in which some people did not turn, and that أبو بكر^{رضي} sent armies and commanders **to be a support to whichever believers were already in that region**. The fifth of the spoils came back to المدينة and was spent among the people. And it

went on that way until there was nobody left in the peninsula except people in obedience and people under a covenant of protection — like the people of نجران, who had sent a delegation to renew theirs while Muslim tribes were breaking theirs.

Let the author have the last word on his own material. Read it as his verdict, not yours.

ما من ناحية من جزيرة العرب إلا وحصلَ في أهلها ردةٌ لبعض الناس، فبعثَ
الصدِّيقُ إليهم جيوشًا وأمراءَ يكونون عونًا لمن في تلك الناحية من المؤمنين ... ولم
يزل الأمر كذلك حتى لم يبق بجزيرة العرب إلا أهل طاعة لله ولرسوله، وأهل ذمة من
الصدِّيق، كأهل نجران وما جرى مجراهم والله الحمد.
وعامة ما وقع من هذه الحروب كان في أواخر سنة إحدى عشرة وأوائل سنة ثنتي
عشرة.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3189> · البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٤٣ —

English: "There was no region of the Arabian peninsula in which apostasy did not occur among some of its people; so al-Ṣiddīq sent them armies and commanders to be a support to whichever believers

were in that region ... And matters continued so until there remained in the peninsula none but

people obedient to Allah and His Messenger, and people under al-Ṣiddīq's protection, such as the

people of Najrān. The general run of these wars was in the last part of the year 11 and the first

part of the year 12."

عبرت: The armies were sent to hold up people who were already standing, and the whole thing was over in a little more than a year.

21 • ★ The call does not add numbers; it removes rivalry

Ask the question before you answer it, because everyone in the room is already holding it: a peninsula that has just fragmented is moving against two empires within two years. How?

Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله's answer does not multiply anyone's numbers. He says a religious call takes away the rivalry and the mutual envy that exist among people bound by kin, and points them all one way. Once that happens nothing stands in front of them — because the direction is one, the object is equal in every eye, and they will die for it. He names the conquests as his own example.

والسبب في ذلك ... أنَّ الصبغة الدينية تذهب بالتنافس والتحاسد الذي في أهل
العصبية وتفرد الوجهة
إلى الحق فإذا حصل لهم الاستبصار في أمرهم لم يقف لهم شيء لأنَّ الوجهة واحدة
والمطلوب متساو عندهم
وهم مستميتون عليه

— ١٩٨ ص ١ ج ١ تاريخ ابن خلدون · <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/196>

English: "The reason for it ... is that the religious colouring takes away the rivalry and mutual

envy that are in people of عصبية, and makes their direction single, towards the truth.

Then, once

clear sight in their affair is theirs, nothing stands in their way — because the direction is one,

the object is equal in all their eyes, and they will die for it."

عبرت: What changed in Arabia was not how many men there were, but which way they were all facing.

⚠ **Say his name, and say "as he reads it".** Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله never wrote this about the ردة. Joining his chapter to the year eleven is our doing, and the slide must show that it is. This is the one place tonight where you are offering an interpretation rather than a report, and the room must be able to hear the difference.

 **[WORKSHEET — 90 seconds, silent]** Mark three places on the blank map. Write the years into three of the six timeline boxes. **Say nothing while they write.**

Telling it: About three minutes for the two narrative cards, then card 21 as the hinge into the break. Then the worksheet, and the hardest instruction of the night: *stop talking*. Ninety seconds of silence feels like five minutes on stage. Do not fill it, do not explain the worksheet twice, do not walk about. Stand still, let them write, watch the clock — that silence is what makes the second half feel like a fresh start. If you are running long, tell دارين in three sentences: roads closed, water crossed, back the same day. But **card 20 stays** — it is Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله's own verdict, and it is what keeps the ردة section from sounding like a conquest narrative. **What not to say:** do not draw any present-day parallel from card 21. None. The moment عصيبة becomes a comment on anything current you have started adjudicating, and this room holds settled views. State it as Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله's reading of the past, and move on.

If a slip asks — "why is Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله being quoted here?" He is used in this course for judgement and framing only, never as the authority for a date, a name or a number, and he is always named. Tonight he supplies one explanation, labelled as his, of something the narrative sources report but do not explain. That is exactly the use he is admitted for.

ACT 6 • Outward

12–13 AH

22 • The order to Iraq

Here the map stops being Arabia. The first arrow leaves the peninsula — from اليمامة east to the lower Euphrates — and for the rest of the series Arabia is no longer the whole board. Mark that moment for the room.

خالد^{رض} had just finished اليمامة when a letter came from المدينه. It did not say "conquer Iraq." It said: come at Iraq from its lower end. Call the people to God. If they answer, they are Muslims — what is yours is theirs. If they refuse, take the jizya. If they refuse that, fight.

And then two restrictions that are easy to miss and are the reason this card is in the evening at all. Do not compel any man to march with you. And do not use any man who apostatised, even if he has come back.

وَأَنْ يَتَأَلَّفَ النَّاسَ وَيَدْعُوهُمْ إِلَى اللَّهِ ، فَإِنْ أَجَابُوا وَإِلَّا أَخَذَ مِنْهُمْ الْجِزْيَةَ فَإِنْ امْتَنَعُوا
عَنْ ذَلِكَ قَاتِلْهُمْ ،
وَأَمْرُهُ أَنْ لَا يُكْرِهَ أَحَدًا عَلَى الْمَسِيرِ مَعَهُ ، وَلَا يَسْتَعِينُ بِمَنْ ارْتَدَّ عَنِ الْإِسْلَامِ وَإِنْ كَانَ
[قَدْ] عَادَ إِلَيْهِ

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٦٢ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3208>

English: "...that he should win the people over and call them to God; if they answered, well, and

if not, take the jizya from them; and if they refused that, fight them. And he ordered him not to

compel anyone to march with him, and not to make use of any man who had apostatised from Islam,

even if he had returned to it."

عبرت: A state that has just won a civil war and still refuses to conscript the defeated is telling you what it thinks it is for.

23 • The march across the waterless desert

This is the map moment of the second half. A line strikes north-west out of Iraq at Qurāqir, crosses blank desert with no road on it, and comes out at Suwā and Tadmur — behind the Roman armies.

The commanders in Syria wrote to أبو بكر asking for reinforcement and telling him what the Romans had gathered at the Yarmūk. He wrote back to خالد in Iraq: put a deputy over Iraq, bring the men you have to Syria, and when you reach them you are the commander over them. خالد set off at once — but not by any road. He chose the Samāwa, waterless country.

His guide was Rāfi' b. 'Umayra al-Tā'ī, and Rāfi' told him plainly it could not be done with cavalry and baggage: a lone rider fears that road. خالد said he had no choice; he had to come out behind the Romans.

So they prepared, and the preparation is the part worth telling slowly, because nobody in the room will have heard it. The strongest camels were made thirsty, then watered twice over, their lips cut and their mouths bound so they could not chew and lose the water. Every day they opened the bellies of ten of them and watered the horses from what was inside.

On the last stretch Rāfi', whose eyes were bad, asked the men whether they could see a box-thorn bush the height of a seated man. They said no. He said: then by God you are dead, and I am dead with you. They looked again. The bush was there, cut down to a stump. They dug at its root and found the spring.

وَاللّٰهُ مَا وَرَدْتُ هٰذَا الْمَاءَ قَطُّ اِلَّا مَرَّةً وَاحِدَةً مَعَ اَبِيْ وَاَنَا غُلَامٌ

— ٢٥٣ ص · الكامل فى التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/944>

English: "By God, I have come to this water only once in my life — with my father, when I was a boy."

عبرت: The march was survived on preparation and on one man's memory; neither was an accident.

Length of the march: البدايه says nine days; الكامل and سير say five nights. **Say both**, in one breath, and move on. Saying both costs four seconds and buys you the room's trust for the rest of the evening.

24 • خالد hands the command round

The Muslim armies came to the Yarmūk still divided — four commanders, each over his own men, nobody over all of them. The Roman camp was at al-Wāqūṣa with a ravine at its back and the Muslim line sitting across the only road out.

On the morning of the battle خالد stood up and made a proposal. He did not ask for the command. He proposed that they pass it round: one of us today, another tomorrow, another the day after, until every one of us has held it — *and let me have today*. They made him commander, expecting the arrangement to last a long time.

It lasted one day.

إن هذا يوم من أيام الله، لا ينبغي فيه الفخر ولا البغي ... فتعالوا فلتتعاور الإمارة
فليكن عليها بعضنا
اليوم والآخر غدًا والآخر بعد غد، حتى يتأمر كلكم، ودعوني اليوم أليكم

— البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٨٩ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3235>

English: "This is a day of God's days — there should be no boasting in it and no aggression ...

So come, let us take the command in turn: one of us today, another tomorrow,
another the day

after, until every one of you has commanded. And let me have charge of you today."

عبرت: The man who asked for one day got the day; a man who had demanded the whole command might have got neither.

25 • "Armies are made many by victory"

خالد had come in from Iraq and was looking at the Roman lines. A Christian Arab standing near him said out loud what everyone there could see: how many the Romans are, and how few the Muslims. The answer he got had nothing to do with counting.

ويلك، أتحوّني بالروم؟ وإنما تكثر الجنود بالنصر، وتقل بالخذلان لا بعدد الرجال

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٩٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3238>

English: "Woe to you — are you frightening me with the Romans? Armies are made many by victory and few by abandonment, not by the number of men."

عبرت: Counting the enemy is useful; being governed by the count is not.

This is the right place to be honest about numbers in front of the room, and it will do you credit. Ask them to guess the two army sizes; take three guesses; then show that the books themselves give three different answers, and say why that happens with pre-modern figures. Then put the caveat line on screen under the numbers panel and leave it there.

Telling it: About five minutes, and the pace should pick up — you have come out of a battlefield and a still point, and this act is movement. Three beats: the letter, the desert, the command. **Spend the time on the desert march;** the camels and the box-thorn bush are the kind of detail nobody forgets, and they are on the page. If you are running late, cards 24 and 25 can both go — you lose nothing tonight by stopping the act at the spring. **What not to say:** do not narrate the battle of the Yarmūk. It is not tonight's material, the evening has to reach a deathbed, and starting a battle you cannot finish is the fastest way to lose the last ten minutes.

If a slip asks — "was this aggression? Why march on Iraq at all?" Do not defend and do not apologise; read the letter. It sets an order: call them, then the jizya, then fighting only if both are refused. And it contains two restrictions that an aggressor would not write — no man is compelled to march, and no man who had apostatised is used, even if he had returned. That is what the page says. Whether that satisfies a modern objection is not a question you settle from a lectern, and you can say so pleasantly.

ACT 7 • He dies

13 AH

Nothing moves on the map for the whole of this act. Say that out loud when you get here — the map stops, and the last twenty minutes of the man's life are all indoors. It changes the temperature of the room.

26 • He asks عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رض} about عمر^{رض}

He called عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رض} in and asked him to tell him about عمر^{رض}. عبد الرحمن^{رض} said what everyone in المدينة already thought: he is better than you think — except there is harshness in him.

أبو بكر^{رض} did not argue with the description. He explained it. *He is hard because he sees me being soft. When I was angry with a man, عمر^{رض} showed me leniency; when I was gentle with a man, عمر^{رض} showed me severity. Put the office in his hands and much of that will go.*

فَقَالَ: إِنَّهُ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ رَأْيِكَ إِلَّا أَنَّهُ فِيهِ غِلْظَةٌ. فَقَالَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ: ذَلِكَ لِأَنَّهُ يَرَانِي رَقِيقًا،
وَلَوْ أَفْضَى الْأَمْرُ إِلَيْهِ لَتَرَكَ كَثِيرًا مِمَّا هُوَ عَلَيْهِ

— الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦ - <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957>

English: "He said: he is better than your opinion of him — except that there is harshness in

him. Abū Bakr said: that is because he sees me being gentle. If the affair passed to him he would

leave much of what he is now."

عبرت: A man's edge is often the shape of the gap he thinks he is filling.

27 • "I have not appointed a relative over you"

The document was finished and he ordered it read out. The people gathered. The letter went with a freedman of his, and عمر^{رض} walked beside him telling the crowd to be quiet and listen. It was read. They said: we hear and we obey.

Then أبو بكر^{رض} looked out over them himself and asked them a question — *are you content with the man I have appointed?* And then he told them the thing nobody had asked him.

أَتَرْضُونَ بِمَنْ اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ؟ فَإِنِّي مَا اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ ذَا قَرَابَةٍ، وَإِنِّي قَدْ
اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ عُمَرَ فَاسْمَعُوا لَهُ وَأَطِيعُوا، فَإِنِّي وَاللَّهِ مَا أَلَوْتُ مِنْ جُهِدِ الرَّأْيِ.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/958> · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٧

English: "Are you content with the one I have appointed over you? For I have not appointed over you a relative of mine. I have appointed 'Umar over you, so hear him and obey — for by God, I have not fallen short of the utmost of my judgement."

عبرت: He had a son and a family in that city, and he named the hardest man in it instead.

28 • The list of what he owned

He called عائشة ^{رض}. He told her that since the day he took charge of the Muslims' affair he had not eaten a dinar or a dirham of theirs — only the coarsest of their food, only the roughest of their clothing.

Then he listed what was in the house that belonged to the Muslims and not to him. An Abyssinian servant. A camel used for carrying water. The worn nap of one blanket. *When I die, send them to عمر*. She did.

Read the list slowly. Three items. The room will be counting them.

وليس عندنا من فيء المسلمين شيء إلا هذا العبد الحبشي وهذا البعير الناضح وجر
هذه القطيفة، فإذا مت فابعثي بهن إلى عمر، ففعلت.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167> · سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩

English: "We have nothing of the Muslims' fay' except this Abyssinian servant, this water-carrying camel, and the worn nap of this blanket. When I die, send them to 'Umar. And she did."

عبرت: He kept an account of what was not his, and he closed it before he died.

29 • Sell my land and pay them back

He had been given a maintenance out of the treasury. The community voted it to him when he gave up trading, because a man cannot run a market stall and a state at once. It was lawful, it was agreed, and it was his.

On his deathbed he gave an instruction about it. Sell a piece of land of mine. Take the price. Pay it in against every dirham I have drawn.

فَلَمَّا حَضَرَتْهُ الْوَفَاةُ أَوْصَى أَنْ تَبَاعَ أَرْضٌ لَهُ وَيُصْرَفَ ثَمَنُهَا عَوَضَ مَا أَخَذَهُ مِنْ مَالِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ.

— الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957>

English: "When death came to him he directed that land of his be sold and its price paid over in compensation for what he had taken of the Muslims' property."

عبرت: He treated a lawful salary as a debt.

⚠ **Do not give a figure.** The sources give the salary as 6,000 dirhams a year (الكامل ج ٢), as half a sheep a day (سير الراشدون ص ١٤), and as 2,500 (سير الراشدون ص ١٤). The instruction is the point, not the amount, and a figure you cannot defend is worth nothing.

30 • The shroud

He gave instructions for his own washing — his wife أسماء بنت عميس^{رض}, and his son عبد الرحمن^{رض}. Then the shroud. Use the two garments I am wearing, and buy one more to go with them. And he said: the living need the new more than the dead.

وَقَالَ: الْحَيُّ أَحْوَجُ إِلَى الْجَدِيدِ مِنَ الْمَيِّتِ، إِنَّمَا هُوَ لِلْمُهْلَةِ وَالصَّدِيدِ.

— الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/953>

English: "He said: the living have more need of the new than the dead — this is only for the decay."

عبرت: The last instruction he gave about himself was an instruction to spend less on himself.

31 • Monday night, and a grave already dug beside another

He died on the Monday evening. He had asked to be buried beside the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, so they dug there. عمر^{رضي} prayed over him in the Prophet's ﷺ mosque, four takbīrs. They carried him on the same bier the Prophet ﷺ had been carried on. Four men went down into the grave: his son عبد الرحمن^{رضي}, عمر^{رضي}, عثمان^{رضي}, and طلحة^{رضي}. They laid his head at the Prophet's ﷺ shoulders and put his niche against the Prophet's ﷺ niche. He was buried before morning came.

He was sixty-three — the age at which the Prophet ﷺ had died. Say that last, and then stop.

وقالت عائشة: مات ليلة الثلاثاء، ودفن قبل أن يصبح.

— سيرة أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩٦ <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167>

English: "Ā'isha said: he died on the night of Tuesday, and was buried before morning came."

عبرت: Two years and three months of authority, and it ended in a room, at night, with four men and a spade.

The graves diagram is fixed by one sentence on the same page — سيرة أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩٦: <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167>:

رأس أبي بكر عند كتفي رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم، ورأس عمر عند حقوي أبي بكر.

⚠ **Do not say the burial was "in عائشة's house."** These pages say *beside the Prophet ﷺ*, and no more. The date the pages give is Monday evening, with eight nights remaining of جمادى الآخرة, 13 AH.

Telling it: About seven minutes, and it is the whole reason the evening works. Slow to your slowest. Say once, before card 26, that the map has stopped moving — that single sentence tells the room the ending has begun, and they will settle. Four beats: the assessment of عمر^{رضي}, the public appointment, the three objects, the grave. Cards 29 and 30 are short enough to be footnotes to card 28 — a salary repaid, a shroud not bought — which keeps the momentum toward the grave. If you are running late, **cut 29 and 30**,

never 27 or 28. **What not to say:** do not compare him to anyone, and do not draw a governance lesson out loud — the three objects do it silently and better. Do not add a eulogy. The plainest possible delivery of card 31 is the strongest one available to you, and anything you add takes weight out of it.

If a slip asks — "why did he appoint a successor when the Prophet ﷺ did not?" Read what the page records him doing: he consulted, he wrote a document, he had it read aloud in public, he asked the people whether they were content, and he told them unprompted that he had not appointed a relative. That is the record. The wider question of the succession and the disputes around it is handled with اصول in session 3, and you do not settle it from the floor tonight. Use the deferral line in QA_BANK.md §0, warmly, and offer to talk afterwards — you have fifteen minutes after the session and one-to-one is where this conversation belongs.

The close

1. **The Line**, with tonight's events lit up and nothing else — `line_s2_lit.png`.
2. **The Map**, at 13 AH, against where it stood when the room walked in — `map_s2_close_13ah.png`. *(Both of these open session 3 unchanged. That is the whole re-anchor mechanism: the room sees the continuity instead of being told about it.)*
3. **Tonight's عبرت lines**, all on one screen.
4. 🖐️ **[HANDS]** Hands up — what year are we in now?
5. Next week, as a question.
6. A loud السلام عليكم, then the dua. The room must know it has ended.

Telling the close: five minutes, and do not improvise any of it. The last hands-up is not decoration — it is the room proving to itself that it has kept the timeline, and it is the moment they walk out feeling competent. Give them a beat to answer. Then the عبرت screen, read once, without elaboration. Then the question for next week, and nothing after it. The salām is loud on purpose.

The five عبرت lines

⚠ [SLIDES.md](#) did not exist when this briefing was written, so these five are my selection from the 31 cards, not a reading of the deck. Every one is a card's own عبرت line, copied unchanged — no new sentence has been written. **Reconcile against** [SLIDES.md](#) once it exists; if the deck's five differ, the deck wins. They are chosen to span the arc rather than cluster.

1. **There is a kind of steadiness that is not stubbornness: it is refusing to treat an emergency as permission.** (*Act 1, card 2 — جيش أسامة*)
2. **He did not tell them what to do; he told them what they had already been.** (*Act 3, card 13 — Thābit b. Qays at عقرباء*)
3. **Preservation is not one heroic act; it is somebody doing a careful, unglamorous job properly.** (*Act 4, card 18 — زيد and the four materials*)
4. **What changed in Arabia was not how many men there were, but which way they were all facing.** (*Act 5, card 21 — Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله, as he reads it*)
5. **He kept an account of what was not his, and he closed it before he died.** (*Act 7, card 28 — the servant, the camel, the blanket*)

Three alternates, if the deck wants a different balance — all likewise copied from their cards:

- *What people believe about your strength does as much work as your strength does.* (card 5)
- *The recovery came out of the very night the reverse happened, spent preparing.* (card 7)
- *A state that has just won a civil war and still refuses to conscript the defeated is telling you what it thinks it is for.* (card 22)

One rule for all of them: they are drawn from the events and they stay there. No present-day parallel, from the lectern or in answer to a slip. The room contains an organisation with settled views, and the moment a عبرت line is heard as a comment on anything current, you have started adjudicating — which is the one thing this course does not do.